

Shared Riches

With the ongoing tussle between digital and TV broadcasters of IPL, brands' ad choices are getting split between the two mediums

BY PRERNA LIDHOO

► **MARKET RESEARCH PLATFORM** Unomer has found brands like Dream11, Tata Neu, RuPay, JioMart, CRED, Tiago.ev, AJIO, CEAT, Asian Paints, Airtel 5G, etc. to be some of the most visible brands during the broadcast of IPL matches this year. Notice any pattern? Unlike last year, this year's crop of advertisers has a healthy mix of legacy and new-age firms.

Experts point out that apart from the usual suspects

like FMCG, auto and telecom majors, this year's tournament has seen a drastic cut compared to last year when it comes to advertising from new-age firms like BYJU'S and Unacademy, PhonePe, Amazon Prime, Pristyn Care, Zepto, Ather, Meesho and Cars24, among others.

Harish Bijoor, Founder of Harish Bijoor Consults, says one reason could be the funding winter the start-up ecosystem is going through. "There's a start-up funding winter. Investors are talking about profitability and not about GMV, eyeballs, etc.," he says. "IPL seems to have... emerged as a product of choice for a brand manager. There are usual advertisers like FMCG, banking, automotive, etc. who spend as much as eight months of their entire budget on IPL."

Brand experts, however, believe that a lot of companies have started preferring digital as the go-to channel for advertising compared to TV. And data from Broadcast Audience Research Council (BARC) supports that trend, with the number of advertisers on TV (it is being broadcast on Star Sports) having fallen by 42 per cent in the first 29 matches of this season. This year, TV has attracted 47 advertisers so far, compared to 81 in the last season. Brands like CRED, Paytm, Swiggy, Acko, BYJU'S, which until last year had bet big on TV, have given it a miss this year. Amazon, Samsung, Indeed, TVS, Castrol, Noise, Puma, etc., are exclusive to JioCinema—where IPL is be-

Brewing Battle

Pret A Manger, which has forayed into the Indian market, will have to contend with larger rival Starbucks and Indians' affinity for tea

BY ARNAB DUTTA

► **UK-BASED COFFEEHOUSE** chain Pret A Manger recently jumped into the Indian market with its first store in Mumbai's BKC. The brand—that sells organic coffee

